

Vibration White Finger

Doctors in Britain have judged that playing games using gaming consoles is harmful to health. The latest hand-arm vibration syndrome, called Vibration White Finger, afflicted a 15-year-old boy in London due to prolonged usage of a Sony PlayStation games console. He played for as many as seven hours a day. Doctors have lodged a bill with the British Medical Journal asking for such products to be released with a statutory warning.



ILLUSTRATION: Farzana Cooper

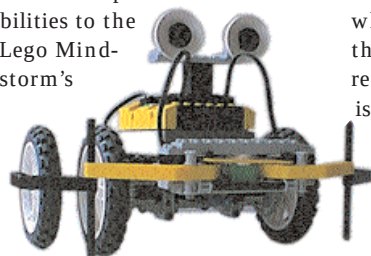
This syndrome also occurs as a result of pro-

longed use of pneumatic industrial equipments. In racing and other driving games the gamepad vibrates to give the rumble effect. This gives the player the feeling that he/she is actually driving the vehicle on the screen.

Sony already has taken the issue into consideration and has started releasing statutory warnings on its gaming devices. Users are now advised to take a 15-minute break after every hour of using the console and gamepad now.

Hyper robot

Olaf Christ has laid the foundation for what he claims to be an RCX (Robot Command Explorer). By transferring Internet capabilities to the Lego Mind-storm's



platform, Christ has created the first RCX ever. Lego is a robot with brains, who has been extremely popular with hobbyists and hackers. RCX is the interface through which the PC connects to the robot and sends and receives data packets. Christ is in the process of building a Lego brick Web server that could enable the control of robots through the Internet.

Rejuvenating Batteries

Imagine charging a battery with a hand-powered pump. This is what Max Smith, an American developer, has imagined with the StepCharger, a product which generates 20 minutes of battery power when you brisk the pump for five minutes. This device can rejuvenate the replaceable battery in any electronic device—mobile phone, video camera, digital camera, MP3 player, etc.

Bananas over Baniyas

Intel's Israel operation is working on a new laptop processor to enable seamlessly connectivity with any available cellular network for accessing the Net without a modem. Code-named "Bania", this laptop processor is slated for release in Jan 2003, and hopes to realise the dream of total connectivity to the Net—anytime, anywhere.

redalert

Don't get giddy

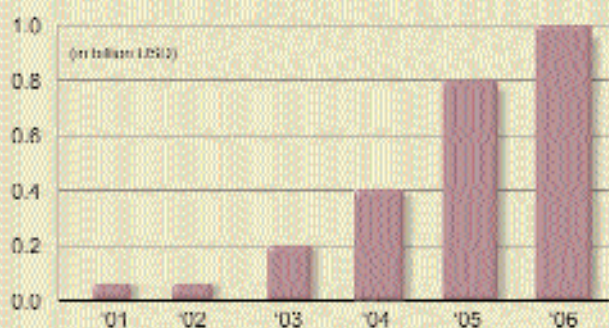
This time around, a JavaScript-based virus threatens to clean your hard disk. The travel mode for Gigger is MS Outlook and mIRC. It spreads across the Internet via these applications. The virus attempts to mail itself to all your contacts as a security update from Microsoft. It usually reaches the recipient with a subject line 'MS Outlook update' along with an attachment 'mmsn_offline.htm'. Microsoft often releases patches and updates through its sites so look out for any e-mail with a similar subject line and delete it. Protection is available with all major anti-virus vendors.

Malicious Morpheus

The popular file sharing software, Morpheus, has a security hole, which throws open all your personal details to the outside world. The security hole allows hackers to generate a random list from the 9-million user base. The hacker can then access the victim's computer and copy files from any drive on his/her computer. The privacy risk was reported first to BBC news online by a group of security experts. Since the software is caught up in copyright issues like Napster, there is no security patch available as of now.

statattack

Digital Music Subscription Sales (2001-2006)



Source: www.jmm.com

snapshot

13% of India's adult population accesses the Net

Source: NASSCOM

■ Palm promises Macintosh compatibility with PDAs ■ BPL mobile 5th provider of GPRS in the world ■ GeForce4 released ■ HECL has launched